side by side with the tailors and became known as mistress dress makers.

In general, the apparel industry concentrates on three major methods of garment making namely home-made, tailor made and ready-made.

11.2 Home Made Garments

Home-made garment, as the name indicates are the clothes stitched by the family members for the family members or friends.

11.2.1 History of Home-made Garments

Home sewing remained an individual endeavour until 1863, when Ebenezer Butterick, a tailor and shirt maker by trade, in collaboration with his wife, Ellen, put on the market a set of shirt patterns. All garments were sewn by hand until the development of the sewing machine, which was first introduced in the early 1850.

11.2.2 Description of Home-made Garments

Home-made garments are constructed efficiently at home as and when required for the family members and also express their talents and interest of the member who sews the garment. If the members in the family are interested and talented in garment construction, they can very well produce garments in the home.

Those who make their own clothing at home have several reasons for doing so. The reasons will vary from family to family, based on the degree of importance given to a particular reason. Home sewing may be done to stretch the family budget although studies indicate that this factor is not as important as it once was.



Figure 11.1 Homemade Garments

11.2.3 Merits of Home-made Garments

- More economical in garment making especially for middle income and low income families
- Requires and increases special talent and involvement among families
- Need not depend on any one outside agent for their garments
- It helps to create unique style among others
- Even though it is time consuming, satisfaction could be achieved in fit and comfort
- Quality garments could be produced based on the availability of the sewing machines and finishing machines
- Motivate creativity among family members.
- Express individual's knowledge and skill in construction.
- Enrichment of the knowledge experience is possible by multiple and regular constructions.
- Applications of CAD in home sewing simplify the procedure.

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